



TOP 10 TIPS FOR YOUR TOP 10 CUSTOMERS

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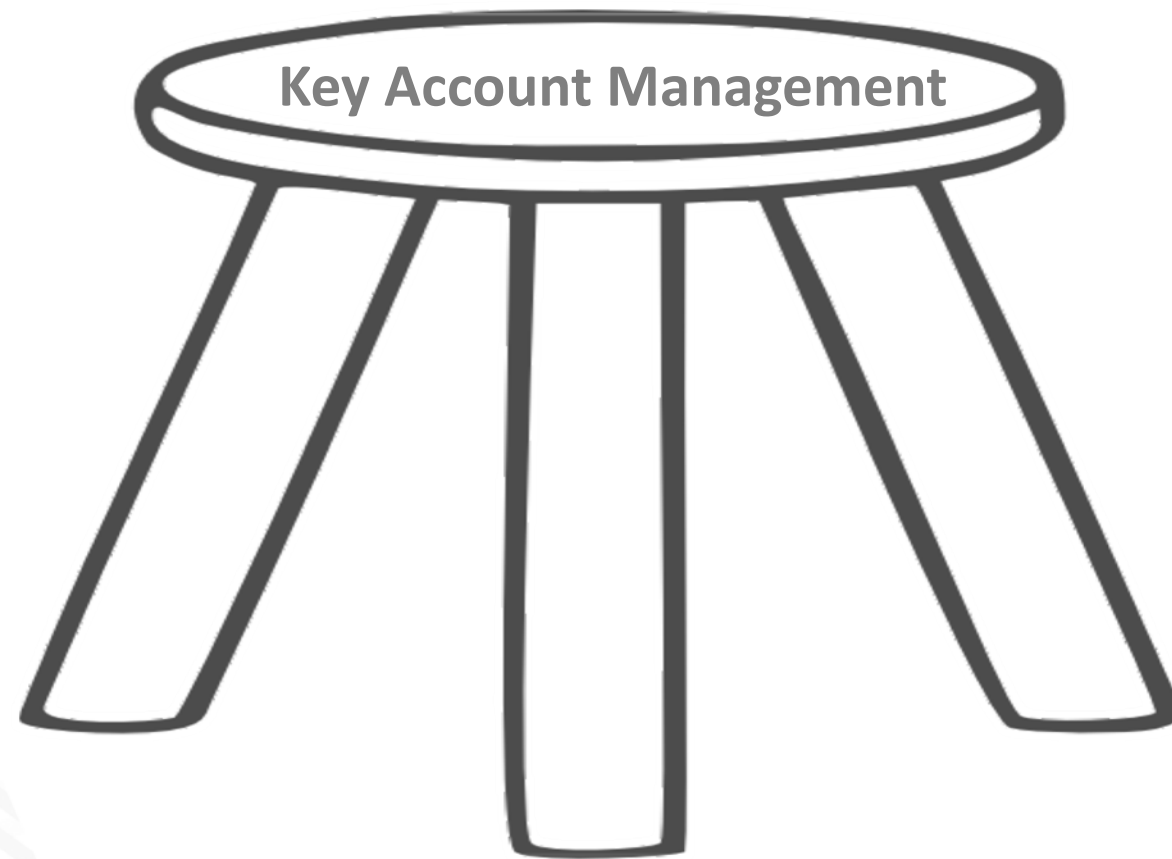
DAVID VENTURA





The First Rule of
Business:

“Look After Your
Most Important
Customers
Before Someone
Else Does!”



Strategies

Systems

Skills





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TOP 10 TIPS FOR YOUR TOP 10 **CUSTOMERS**

DAVID VENTURA & PHIL JESSON



**LOOK
AFTER YOUR
MOST IMPORTANT
CUSTOMERS
BEFORE
SOMEONE ELSE
DOES!**





SUSPECTS: IDENTIFIED BUT NOT
YET CONTACTED OR VISITED

PROSPECTS: Visited But Not Yet
Buying

CUSTOMERS: Buying Regularly
From You

KEY CUSTOMERS: Top Ten ???



FIVE ESSENTIALS	FIVE DESIRABLES
• “Headroom” i.e. potential for growth • Good existing relationships • Same values and beliefs • Where quality is more important than price • Account is in target growth market	• Customer unaffected by outside factors • They have prestige value • Scope for broadening services • Competitor experiencing problems • Their business is growing

Dictionary

Enter a word, e.g. 'pie'



Key Account

[kee uh-kount]

noun

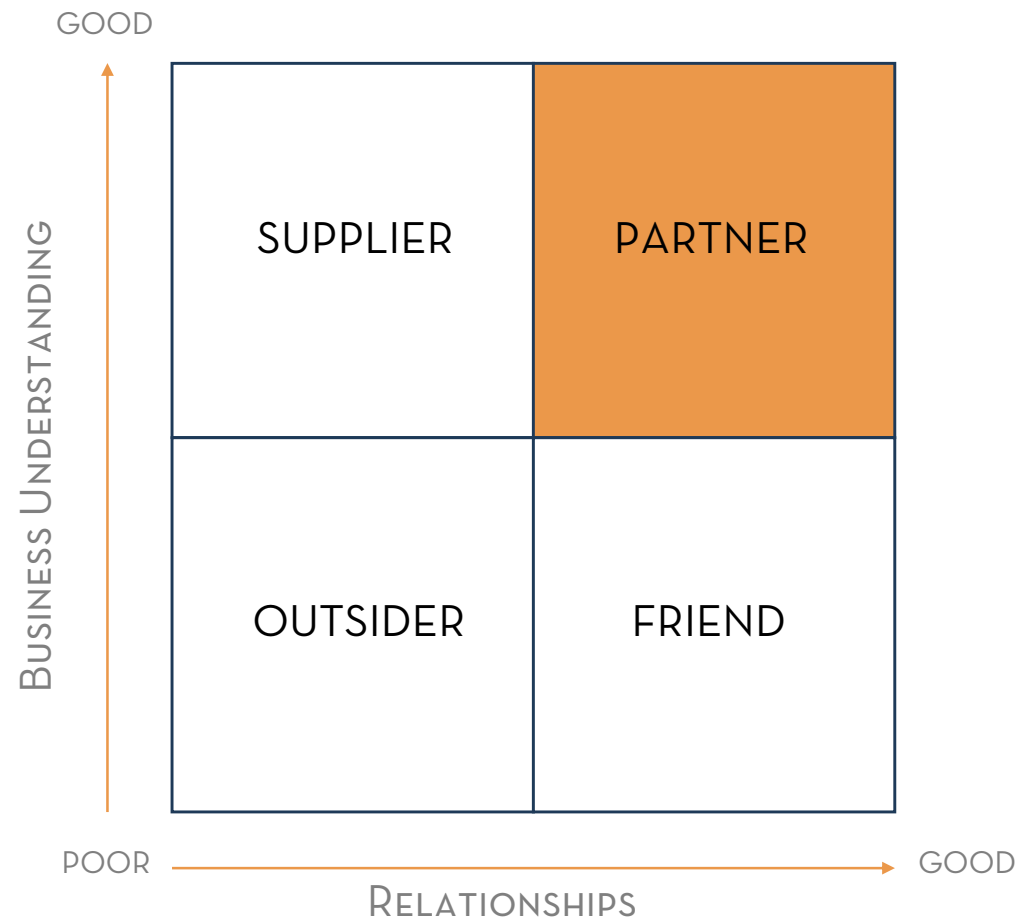
1. Whatever is (or will be)
important to your business



HEALTH CHECK QUESTIONS



- WHAT IS THE DEFINITION FOR A KEY ACCOUNT IN YOUR BUSINESS?
- DO YOUR PEOPLE KNOW?
- ARE THEY 'HUNTING' THE KEY ACCOUNTS OF TOMORROW?



PARTNERSHIP INDICATORS

- They give you confidential information
- Good multi-level relationships
- No nasty surprises
- Price resistance drops, over time
- They accept new products/services



No.	Partnership Indicators	✓ X
1	They tell you that you are a partner	✓
2	There is clear evidence of added value and ROI	✓
3	You understand their future strategy	X
4	They give you confidential information	✓
5	There are no nasty surprises in the relationship	✓
6	Strong multi-level relationships	X
7	More sales and profit	✓
8	They accept your suggestion for new products	✓
9	Price resistance drops, over time	X
10	They ask for advice – not just on your core services	✓
11	You have a rolling agreement, not fixed term	X
12	Reverse hospitality - they pay!	✓
13	They invite you to shape tenders etc	✓
14	Joint action plans in place	X
15	They give you referrals	✓
16	Case studies and testimonials	✓
17	Logos appear side by side	✓
18	Tolerance in the event of a problem	✓
19	All feedback is welcomed and dealt with openly	X
20	They bend the rules to accommodate you	X
Totals		13 out of 20



HEALTH CHECK QUESTIONS



- HOW MANY PARTNERS TODAY?
- WHAT ARE YOUR INDICATORS?



IF YOUR BUSINESS WAS
ARRESTED AND CHARGED
WITH “PLANNING TO ADD
VALUE TO CUSTOMERS”,
WOULD THERE BE ENOUGH
EVIDENCE TO CONVICT IT?



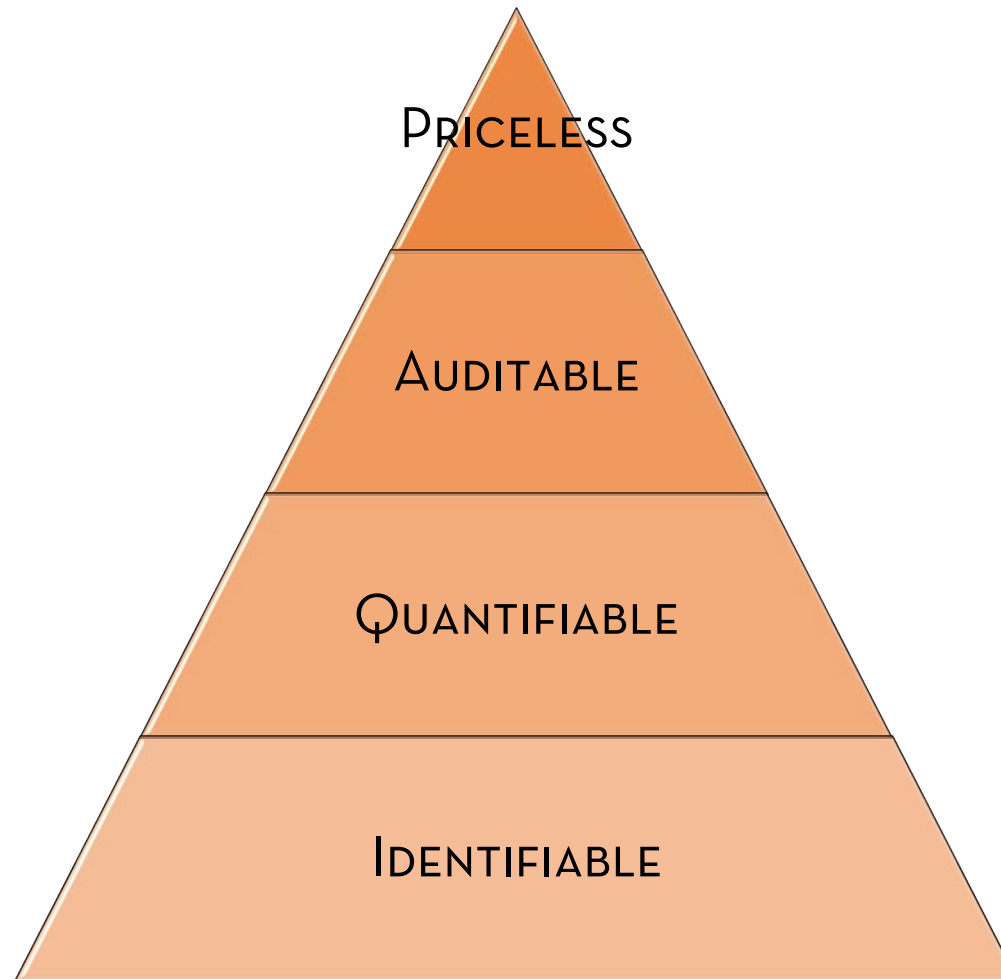
KEY QUESTIONS

HOW DOES YOUR BUSINESS TRACK
AND MEASURE THE VALUE IT CREATES
FOR CUSTOMERS?

.... HOW DO YOU USE THIS TO RETAIN
AND WIN KEY ACCOUNTS?



THE VALUE PYRAMID



HEALTH CHECK QUESTIONS



- HOW MANY 'WOW' TESTIMONIALS DO YOU HAVE?
- IF YOUR BUSINESS CEASED TO EXIST, WHAT WOULD CUSTOMERS MISS?
- HAVE YOU GOT A BANK OF TAILORED CASE STUDIES?

CUSTOMER SATISFACTION



AUDIT QUESTIONS

- Where are we meeting your expectations?
- Where are we exceeding expectations?
- Where are we falling short?
- What unresolved issues are there?
- How do we compare to other suppliers?
 - In our industry?
 - All others?
- How would you sum us up in a sentence?
- How many marks out of ten?
- If we were an animal or bird what would we be?



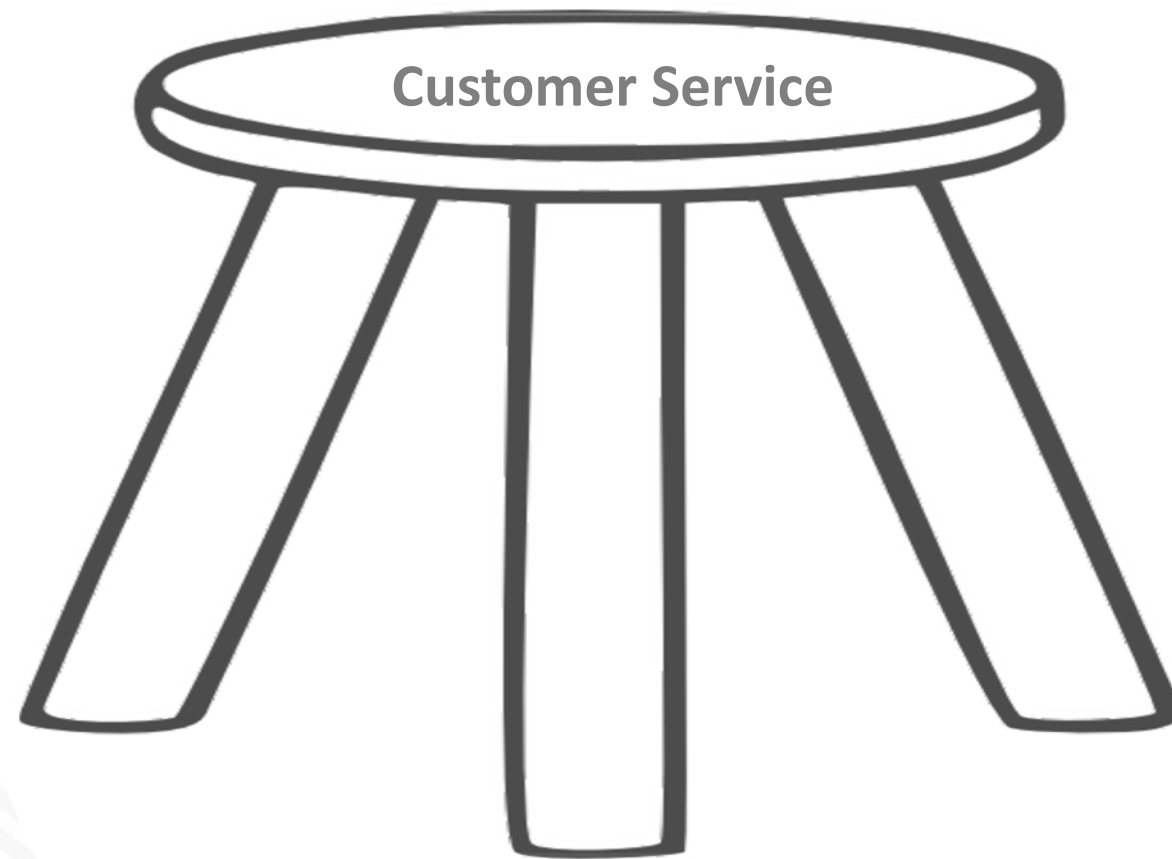
AUDIT QUESTIONS – THE FUTURE

- How is your business changing and developing?
- What pressures will you face?
- What are your main objectives for the future and how will you achieve them?
- How could we help you? How could we add more value?
- How will you measure us in the future?
- What do you see as being the big issues for our relationship in the future?
- What could we do for you that we are not currently doing?
- What would we have to do to score 10 out of 10?
- Where would you be happy to see us have more of your business?
- Is there anything else I need to know?



*“KAM IS A LOT LIKE
TENNIS – THOSE THAT
DON’T SERVE WELL,
LOSE!”*





Strategies

Systems

Skills



EXCEEDS
EXPECTATIONS
FALLS SHORT



EXCEEDING EXPECTATIONS

STAGES	TYPICAL EXPERIENCE	XX FACTOR
ENQUIRY		
CHECK-IN		
ROOM		
BAR & RESTAURANT		
CHECK-OUT		



EXCEEDING EXPECTATIONS

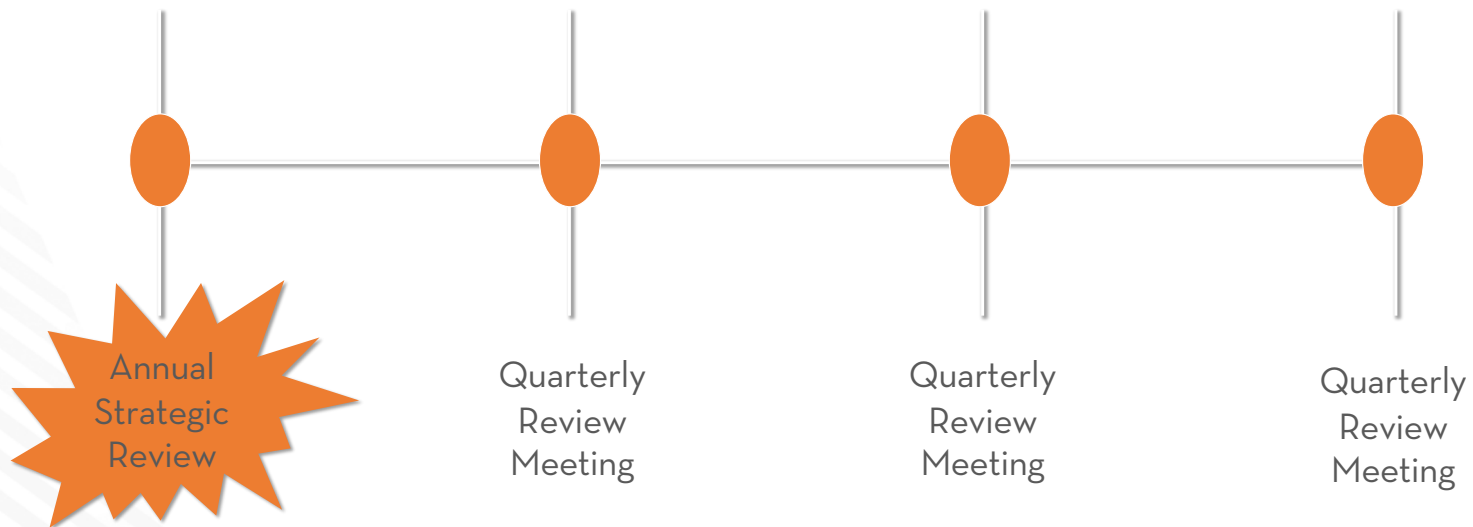
STAGES	TYPICAL EXPERIENCE	XX FACTOR
ENQUIRY	• POLITE • FRIENDLY • TAKE DETAILS • CONFIRM BOOKING WITHIN 24 HOURS	• VERY POLITE AND FRIENDLY STAFF • USE THE CUSTOMER'S NAME FREQUENTLY • ASK QUESTIONS <i>E.G. WAS THERE ANY PARTICULAR REASON WHY YOU WERE INTERESTED IN THAT WEEKEND?" AND "WHAT SORT OF THINGS WERE YOU PLANNING TO DO OR SEE?" AND "ARE THERE ANY SPECIAL NEEDS WE NEED TO BE AWARE OF?"</i> • AS A RESULT OF QUESTIONS ABOVE, OFFER TO BOOK VENUES, TAXIS OR SEND DETAILS/WEBLINKS ETC • SAY THAT YOU ARE LOOKING FORWARD TO WELCOMING THEM • IMMEDIATE CONFIRMATION OF BOOKING

BECOME THE EXPERT IN THEIR WORLD

TODAY	1. CUSTOMER					FUTURE					
• £52m Turnover	SERVICE EXPERIENCE	ACQUISITION	K.A.M.	BRANDING	MARKET RESEARCH	• £72m Turnover					
• 22% Margin						• 25% Margin					
• 3 Main Services						2. SERVICES					• 5 Main Services
• 3 Main Markets						TECHNOLOGY PRODUCTS	LIFE-CYCLES	INTEGRATED SOLUTIONS	• 3 Main Markets		
• Confused Identity									• Clear Identity		
• Contract Loss Rate 17%	3. PEOPLE					• Contract Loss Rate 10%					
• 2200 Staff	CULTURE	STRUCTURE	COMMUNICATION SUCCESSION		RECRUITMENT	• To be in Top 100 Companies to work for					
• 3000 Customers inc. 12 Key Accounts						4. SYSTEMS					• 3600 Customers inc. 100 Key Accounts
• No. 8 in the Market	C.R.M.	REAL-TIME FINANCIALS	PERSONNEL/ PURCHASING		• No. 1 in Chosen Market						
• Staff Turnover 25%					• Staff Turnover 20%						



REVIEW MEETINGS



KEY QUESTIONS

WHO SHOULD MANAGE EACH KEY ACCOUNT?

WHAT DOES THE RECRUITMENT PROFILE LOOK LIKE FOR AN “ACCOUNT MANAGER”?



KASH PROFILE

Knowledge	Scoring									
Customer's Products & Markets	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Customer's Competitors	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Customer's Strategies and Plans	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Products / Services	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Competitors	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Own Structure, Processes Polices	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Current and Likely Legislation	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Business Planning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Customer Profile	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
IT	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	

Attitudes	Scoring									
Team Player	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Genuinely Customer Focused	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Well Rounded Outlook	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Positive - Sees Solutions	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Open Minded	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Goal Orientation	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Challenging Sacred Cows	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Being a Catalyst for Change	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Competitive Instinct	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Strong and Resilient	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	



KASH PROFILE

Skills	Scoring									
Research and Planning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Questioning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Listening and Summarising	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Presenting Tailored Solutions	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Selling Financial Benefits	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Operating at Board Level	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Written Proposals and Letters	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Group Presentations	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Negotiating	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Influencing the Tender Process	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Persuading and Educating Customers	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Internal Marketing / Persuasion	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Organising and Running Customer Meetings	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Time Management	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Networking Skills	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Chairing Meetings with Colleagues	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Closing / Gaining Commitment	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
"Partner Planning"	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	

Habits	Scoring									
Punctuality	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Well-Organised	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	
Appearance	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	



Dictionary

Enter a word, e.g. 'pie'



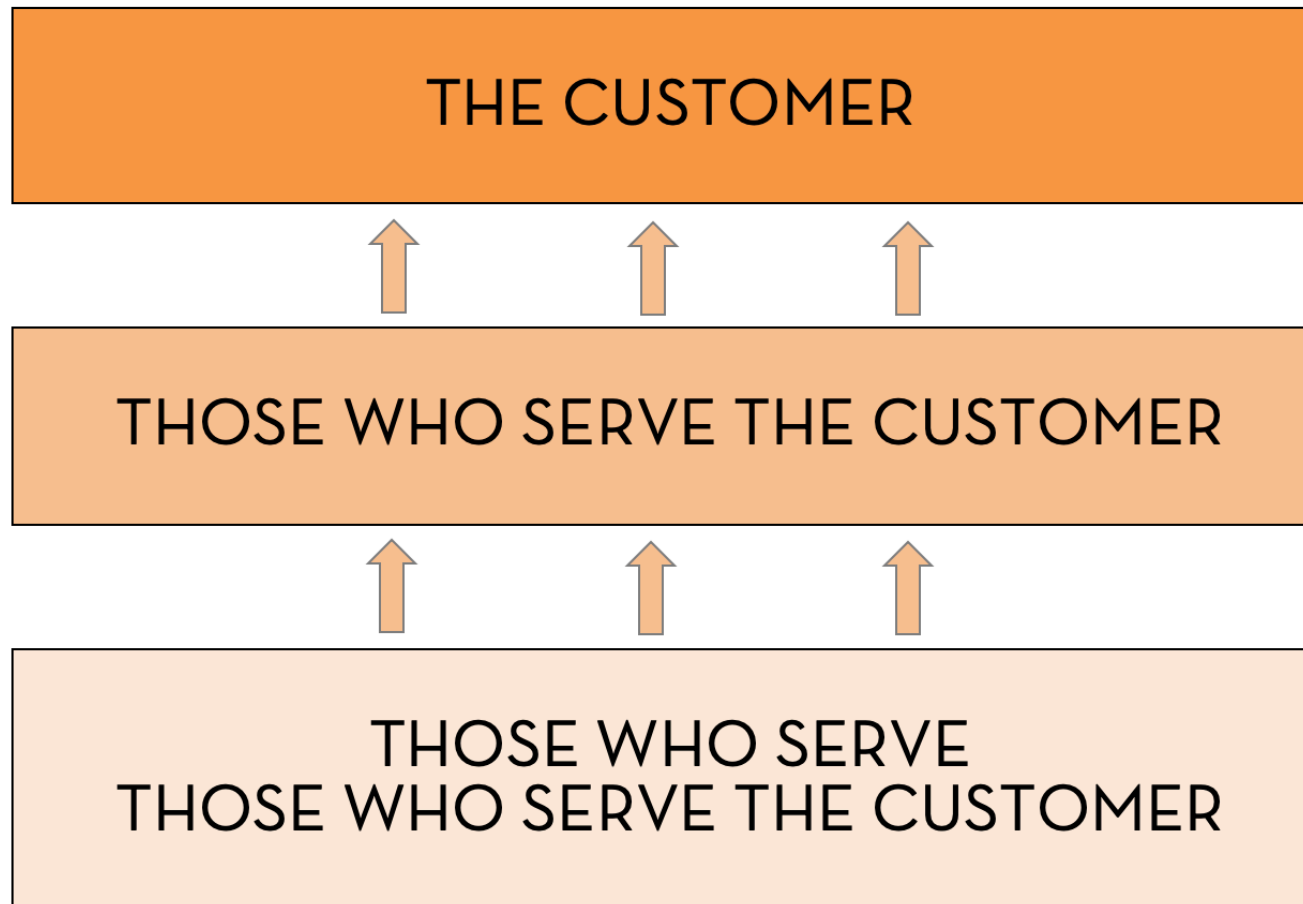
Profitablity

[pro-fitta-bilitee]

noun

1. Downstream consequence of exceptional people delivering exceptional service!

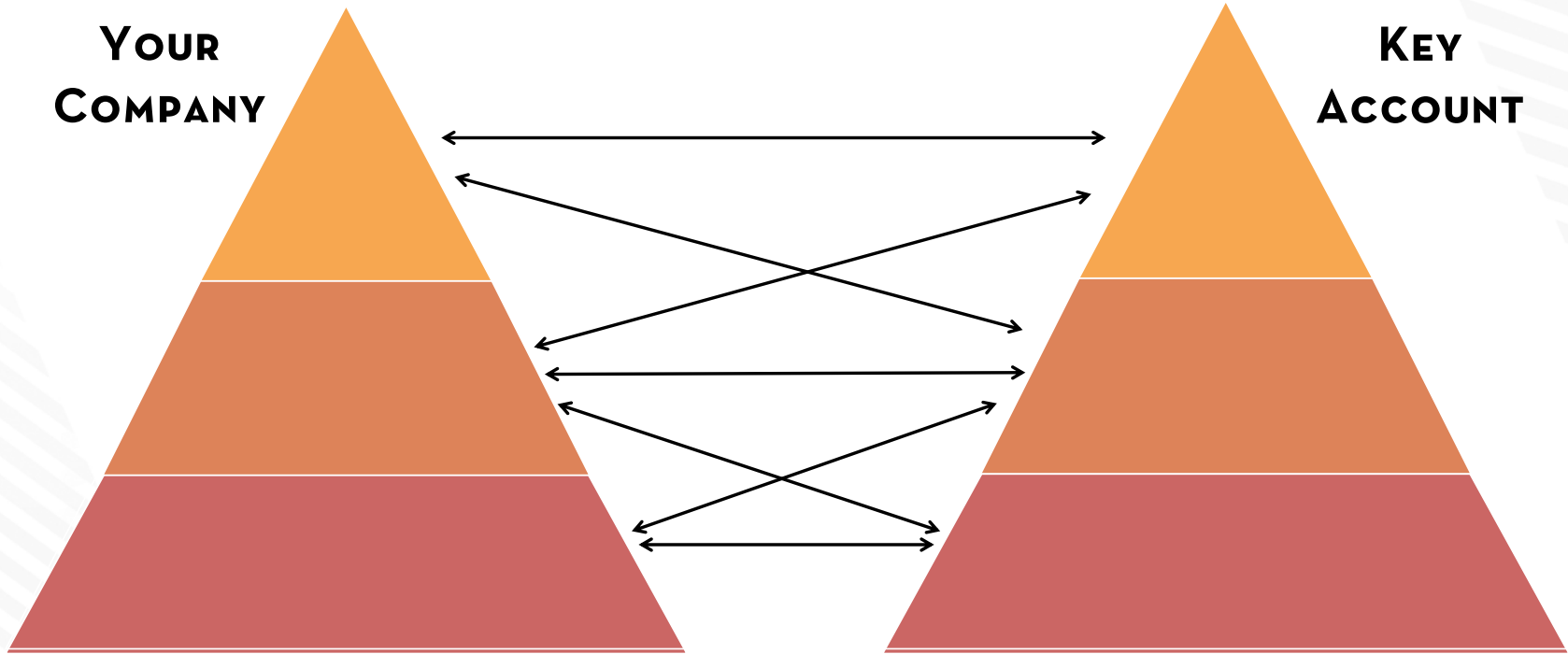




THE KAM TEAM

**YOUR
COMPANY**

**KEY
ACCOUNT**



TEAM DIARY

“KEY ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT IS A TEAM SPORT!”

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
1	2	3	4 TEAM KAMDAY	5
8	9	10 SALES DIR AVAILABLE	11	12
15	16 TEAM KAMDAY	17	18	19
22	23	24	25	26 SALES DIR AVAILABLE
29 CEO K/A AUDIT	30 CEO AVAILABLE	31		

“NONE OF US IS AS STRONG AS ALL OF US!”



SKILLS MATRIX

Team	Food Sector	Transport & Logistics	Printing	Professional Services
Keith	✓	✓*		
Sheila		✓		✓*
Mike	✓*		✓*	
Pat	✓*			



**THE QUALITY OF THE
SERVICE WE GIVE THE
CUSTOMER IS
INFLUENCED BY THE
QUALITY OF SERVICE WE
GIVE EACH OTHER!**



HEALTH CHECK QUESTIONS



- IS KEY ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT A TEAM SPORT?
- DO YOU HAVE AN “OUR CUSTOMER” OR “MY CUSTOMER” CULTURE?
- WHO OWNS THE CUSTOMER?



INTELLIGENCE

WHAT IS THE
CURRENT
SITUATION?



INTENTIONS

WHAT ARE THE
PLANS FOR THE
FUTURE?



IMPLEMENTATION

WHO IS GOING
TO DO WHAT BY
WHEN?

INTELLIGENCE

WHAT IS THE CURRENT SWOT SITUATION?

- PARTNERSHIP INDICATORS
- ORGANISATION CHART
- KPIs & “NUMBERS”
- ALLIES & ENEMIES
- KEY ACCOUNT AUDIT
- KEY PERSONNEL
- FAVOURS LOG
- SUPPLIER SPLIT
- STRATEGIC BRIDGES



	Harry Williams	Very Positive Ally		
		Positive		Sue Jackson
		Interested		
Minor Decision Influencer	Major Decision Influencer	 KAMGURU JUMP AHEAD OF YOUR COMPETITORS	Minor Decision Maker	Major Decision Maker
Tom Chaudhary		Indifferent		
		Negative		
		Very Negative Enemy		Dick Hall

KEY PERSONNEL

	TOM CHAUDHARY	DICK HALL	HARRY WILLIAMS	SUE JACKSON
Job Title	Commercial Manager	FD	CEO	SD
In Job Since	2010	1995	2009	2007
Pa	Jane Wicks	Jane Wicks	Celia Gray	Pat Reynolds
Reports To	Dick	Harry	Chairman Mary Cooper	Harry
Next Likely Job	Production for 2 years	CEO when Harry promoted	Group CEO in 2 years	Early retirement
Dietary	Does not eat fish	Wheat allergy	Loves pasta + real ale	Veggie + fine wines
Claims To Fame	Appeared in EastEnders	Met Margaret Thatcher	Gulf War 1990	Sailed alone across Atlantic
No Go Areas	Politics	Labour Party	Chelsea FC	Fox hunting
Hot Buttons	Karting Liverpool FC	Venice, Rome	Arsenal FC	Sailing, surfing, canoeing
Family	Married with twin girls	Widowed- three sons	Married to Ann - son at University	Partner Tim - no children
Motivator	Achievement	Security	Affiliation	Influence
Key Dates	?	?	Birthday 12/05/60	Getting married next May



SUPPLIER SPLIT

Suppliers	Prod 1	Prod 2	Prod 3	Prod 4	Prod 5	Prod 6	Prod 7	Prod 8	Total
Us!!!		£7k	£14k	£2k	£5k				£28k
Woodside Ind's	£10k	£2k	£4k	£25k					£41k
Rush	£5k	£2k	£6k	£4k	£5k	£9k			£31k
KFL	£20k	£3k	£3k		£18k		£20k		£64k
Total	£35k	£14k	£27k	£31k	£28k	£9k	£20k		£164k

INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
• Good feedback from Key Account Audit (Harry and Sue) • Good multi-level contacts (five on our side, four on theirs) • We know a lot about their key people	• Partnership indicators (was 17 last year) • Dick refused to take part in key account audit • We do not have a Strategic Bridges understanding • Three competitors in the account – we are smallest
OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
• Secure a testimonial from Sue • Woodside Sales Executive gone • Customer not happy with Rush – seen as “arrogant and complacent”	• Dick may become only decision maker if Sue is not replaced • If they decide to reduce suppliers we could be “out”



KAM PLAN

INTENTIONS

WHAT ARE THE
PLANS FOR THE
FUTURE?

- TO ADD VALUE TO THEM
- TO IMPROVE YOUR BUSINESS
- TO DEVELOP RELATIONSHIPS



INTENTIONS

To Add Value To Them	1. To introduce them to our Recruitment Consultancy by end of October 2. Give them a lead - Winterton Ltd, by end of October 3. ?
To Improve Our Business	4. Win half of Rush business by March 5. Attack Woodside whilst they are looking for replacement rep - now! 6. Secure testimonial from Sue before she leaves
To Develop Relationships	7. To carry out at Key Account Audit with Dick and Harry, November 18 8. Take Harry and Tom to Liverpool Vs Arsenal, Feb 23 9. ?



IMPLEMENTATION

IMPLEMENTATION

WHO IS GOING TO
WHAT BY WHEN?

- 12-18 MONTH CALENDAR
- BUILD AROUND THEIR TIMINGS
- START WITH THE END IN MIND







“Between stimulus and response there is a space. In that space is our power to choose our response.

In our response lies our growth and our freedom”

Viktor Frankl





IF IT IS TO BE, IT IS UP TO ME